

Pradipta Das Sarkar

DESIGN LEADER — PRODUCT, PLATFORM & EXPERIENCE

Team Building | Design Strategy | Platform Thinking | Product Innovation | Design Systems

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Design leader and hands-on product design practitioner with 19 years of experience building teams and shaping complex digital products across cybersecurity, networking, financial services, healthcare, and telecommunications. Currently Lead Product Designer at Cisco, with leadership responsibilities spanning hiring, mentoring, design direction, platform strategy, cross-functional alignment, and product execution.

Known for developing designer judgment, creating clarity across teams, raising the quality bar, and taking ideas from problem framing through executive alignment to shipped customer value. M.Des from IDC, IIT Bombay, and Executive General Management alumnus of IIM Bangalore.

Leadership: Team Building, Hiring, Mentoring, Coaching, Talent Development, Design Critique

Strategy: Design Vision, Product and Platform Strategy, Roadmap Influence, Executive Communication

Practice: Product Design, Research, Design Systems, Accessibility, Prototyping, Design Operations

Collaboration: Product, Engineering, Data Science, Research and Business Stakeholder Alignment

Leadership Impact

- Built and developed a core network-security **design team of 16** while providing functional design leadership and mentoring across a wider community of **30+ designers**.
- Contributed to 46+ design hires** across nine years at Cisco through capability planning, portfolio assessment, structured interviews, selection recommendations, and onboarding.
- Led experience design for AgenticOps policy-analysis capabilities **adopted by 5,016 customer tenants** and used to **analyze approximately 128,000 unique security policies**, including **8,500+ manually initiated analyses**.
- Created and championed Rule Heartbeat, selected among the **top 3 of 400+ innovation entries**, presented to executive leadership, and progressed from concept into product implementation.

Professional Experience

Lead Product Designer | Design Leadership, Platform & Product

Lead product and design initiatives across enterprise security and network management while supporting team development, hiring, design quality, platform strategy, and cross-functional decision-making.

Cisco Systems India Pvt. Ltd. | July 2019 - Present

Design Leadership

- Provide functional leadership and mentoring to 30+ designers across multiple product teams, strengthening problem framing, design judgment, storytelling, stakeholder influence, and execution quality.
- Built and developed a core team of 16 network-security designers through hiring, onboarding, coaching, design reviews, and capability development.
- Established critiques, working sessions, and decision checkpoints that created clearer ownership and enabled designers to represent design independently in cross-functional discussions.
- Partner with product, engineering, research, data science, and customer-facing leaders to align design priorities with customer problems, platform strategy, technical constraints, and business goals.

Product, Platform & Craft

- Lead experience strategy and product design across Cisco's enterprise security and network-management portfolio, simplifying high-stakes workflows used to configure, monitor, and protect critical infrastructure.
- Own platform-level experience requirements across on-premises and cloud environments, defining reusable interaction patterns and improving cross-product consistency.
- Co-led the design of Policy Impact Analysis and Software Upgrade Planner, helping firewall operators evaluate change risk before deployment and make safer, evidence-informed upgrade decisions. The experiences received strong customer validation at Cisco Live 2026, with Software Upgrade Planner reaching 536 tenants.
- Use customer research, product data, and rapid prototyping to frame opportunities, validate direction, and connect design decisions to measurable customer and business outcomes.

Senior Product Designer

Cisco Systems India Pvt. Ltd. | Jun 2015 - Jun 2019

- Led end-to-end product design for enterprise firewall and network-security experiences used in technically complex, high-stakes environments.
- Partnered with product management, engineering, research, and customer-facing teams to translate technical requirements into coherent workflows and usable product experiences.
- Led research and usability initiatives to identify customer pain points, validate product direction, and improve design decisions.
- Developed deep domain expertise in cybersecurity while expanding from feature-level execution into product strategy, cross-functional influence, and design leadership.

Senior Product Designer

Oracle India Pvt. Ltd. | Nov 2011 - Jun 2015

- Designed complex enterprise financial workflows across research, problem framing, interaction design, prototyping, and visual refinement.
- Used customer insight, behavioral evidence, and usability evaluation to improve the structure and clarity of dense financial applications.
- Contributed to design-system patterns and interface standards that improved consistency and scalability across products.

Senior UX Designer

HCL Technologies Ltd. | Jul 2010 - Nov 2011

- Led interaction design and information architecture for enterprise healthcare and financial applications.
- Conducted usability evaluation and iterative design improvements to simplify information-rich, business-critical workflows.

User Experience Designer

Tech Mahindra Ltd. | Jul 2007 - Jun 2010

- Designed telecom and enterprise applications using user research, information architecture, interaction design, usability testing, and iterative refinement.
- Built the foundation of a customer-centered and evidence-informed product design practice.

Education

- **Executive General Management Programme** - Indian Institute of Management, Bangalore (2022-2023)
- **M.Des, Visual Communication** - IDC, Indian Institute of Technology, Bombay (2005 - 2007)
- **B.Arch, Architecture** - Jadavpur University (2000 - 2005)

Recognition

- Top 3 of 400+ entries, Cisco Innovation Challenge — Rule Heartbeat
- Winner, Cisco Codex Challenge | 2026
- Cisco Certified Interviewer
- Cisco Design Thinking Practitioner